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Selected research portfolio — prepared for Sanofi Digital Consumer Experience Research Lead application

STUDY 01 · AI GRIEFBOTS & POSTHUMOUS CONSENT

Netnographic audit of posthumous AI discourse · 2024

Method: Netnography · NVivo affinity mapping · Persona development · Journey mapping

Corpus: 50+ Reddit discussions · 500+ coded comments · r/AIEthics, r/GriefSupport, r/DeathPositive

- Produced three proto-personas from affinity-mapped behavioral data (see table below).
- Built a 7-stage user journey tracing the emotional arc from discovery through reckoning.
- Delivered consent-framework design recommendations aligned with GDPR/CNIL posthumous dignity requirements.

Discovery	Consideration	First Contact	Comfort Phase	Friction	Betrayal	Reckoning
Curious / Unsettled	Conflicted / Hopeful	Anxious / Tentative	Relieved / Attached	Confused / Betrayed	Angry / Re-grieving	Reflective / Resigned
OPP Awareness moment	PAIN No consent signal	PAIN Uncanny valley	OPP Emotional need met	PAIN Bot fails user	PAIN Re-traumatization	OPP Consent framework

User journey · 7 stages · Emotional arc · AI Griefbots study (2024)

Archetype	Core Need	Core Pain	Verbatim (coded)
The Skeptic Rights Advocate	Consent sovereignty and data transparency	No posthumous consent mechanism exists	"My dad never agreed to this." — P12
The Seeker Bereaved User	Continued connection and emotional closure	Bot failure causes re-traumatization	"Hearing his voice say 'goodnight, kiddo'" — P42
The Traditionalist Cultural Guardian	Cultural and religious integrity in death	AI disrupts culturally mandated mourning rituals	"Death binds the community." — P21

User archetypes · 3 proto-personas · Affinity-mapped from NVivo-coded corpus

Full case study: josephmarkman.com/griefbots

STUDY 02 · AI-MEDIATED INTIMACY & PARASOCIAL RELATIONSHIPS

Diary study on SocialAI — "The Social Network for One" · 2024–2025

Method: Longitudinal diary studies · Qualitative coding · Behavioral pattern analysis

Platform: SocialAI — all social interactions are AI-generated; a unique site for studying parasocial attachment in practice

- Traced emotional reliance and disclosure escalation patterns over time through coded diary entries.
- Identified three recurring behavioral modes: comfort-seeking, boundary dissolution, and reflexive withdrawal.
- Design directions: legible limits, graduated disclosure scaffolding, dignity-preserving disengagement pathways.

Full case study: josephmarkman.com/digital-intimacy

STUDY 03 · HYPERLOCAL HUMOR & DIGITAL COMMUNITY (@MEMESDELYON)

Mixed-methods study of a Lyon-based Instagram creator · 2023–2024

Method: Semi-structured interviews (French) · Platform metrics analysis · Thematic coding · Qualitative content analysis

- Conducted French-language creator interviews to map content strategy, audience perception, and local cultural knowledge.
- Identified the reach–reaction gap: posts requiring local knowledge to decode outperformed algorithmically broader content.
- Finding: engagement functioned as recognition — communities respond to content that reflects them, not content optimized for scale.

Full case study: josephmarkman.com/memesdelyon

METHODS ACROSS STUDIES

Netnography Diary Studies Semi-structured Interviews (EN/FR) Affinity Mapping NVivo Coding Journey Mapping Persona Development Platform Metrics Analysis Thematic Synthesis